

Complete Step-by-Step Guide: Multi-Station Thermal Printer & KOT Setup

This guide explains how to physically connect, install drivers, and configure separate thermal receipt printers for your **Cashier Desk**, **Hot Kitchen (Rice & Kottu)**, **Juice Bar & Desserts**, and **Bun Counter**.

How Multi-Station KOT Routing Works: When an order containing Fried Rice, Avocado Shake, Brownie, and Chicken Buns is accepted by the Cashier, the POS automatically splits the items and simultaneously sends:

- **Kitchen Ticket:** Prints only Rice, Kottu, and Burgers to the Kitchen Printer.
- **Juice Bar Ticket:** Prints only Juices, Milkshakes, Falooda, and Desserts to the Juice Bar Printer.
- **Bun Counter Ticket:** Prints only Buns, Short Eats, and Rolls to the Bun Counter Printer.

1. Station Overview & Department Mapping

STATION / DEPARTMENT	PHYSICAL LOCATION	RECOMMENDED WINDOWS PRINTER NAME	ASSIGNED MENU CATEGORIES
Billing / Cashier	Main Counter	POS-Cashier	Final Customer Tax Bills (with Restaurant Logo, tender, and change)
Rice & Kitchen	Hot Kitchen	POS-Kitchen	Rice, Kottu, Burgers, Curries, and Hot Meals
Juice Bar & Desserts	Beverage Counter	POS-Juice	Juices, Milkshakes, Falooda, Ice Cream, Brownies & Desserts
Buns & Short Eats	Bakery Display	POS-Buns	Bakery Buns, Rolls, Samosas, Pastries

2. Physical Hardware Connections

Thermal receipt printers can be connected to your POS PC using either **Ethernet (LAN)** or **USB**:

Option A: Ethernet / Network Thermal Printers (Recommended for Kitchen & Juice Bar)

Because the kitchen and juice bar are located away from the cashier desk, long USB cables can fail. Connecting via a standard network cable (Cat5/Cat6) to your Wi-Fi router is the industry standard.

1. Plug a network cable from the printer's **LAN port** into your restaurant's **Wi-Fi Router or Network Switch**.
2. Plug in the power adapter and insert an **80mm / 78mm thermal paper roll**.
3. **Find the Printer's IP Address (Self-Test):** Turn OFF the printer. Hold down the **FEED button**, and while holding it, turn ON the power switch. Keep holding FEED for 3 seconds, then release. The printer will print a test sheet containing its IP address (e.g., `192.168.1.100`).

Option B: USB Cable Connection (Direct to POS PC)

1. Connect the printer's USB cable directly to any USB 2.0 or 3.0 port on the POS computer.
2. Power on the printer. Windows will make a chime sound acknowledging the device.

3. Windows Driver Installation & Printer Setup

Perform these steps on the main POS PC for **each** printer:

1 Install the 80mm POS Thermal Driver

Use the driver CD or download the Windows driver for your printer brand (e.g. *Xprinter*, *Rongta*, *POS-80 Driver*, *Epson TM-T88*). When prompted by the installer, choose "**POS-80**" or "**80mm Series**" and select the port (USB or TCP/IP Network Port).

2 Give Each Printer an Identifiable Name

1. On Windows, open **Settings** → **Bluetooth & devices** → **Printers & scanners**.
2. Click on the newly installed printer and select **Printer properties**.
3. In the **General** tab, rename the printer to match its station:
 - Cashier Printer: rename to **POS-Cashier**
 - Kitchen Printer: rename to **POS-Kitchen**
 - Juice Bar Printer: rename to **POS-Juice**
 - Bun Counter Printer: rename to **POS-Buns**
4. Click **OK** to save.

3 Configure Paper Size (78mm / 80mm Roll)

1. In **Printer properties**, click **Preferences** → **Advanced**.
2. Under **Paper Size**, select **80 x 297 mm** OR **78mm Continuous**.
3. In the **Device Settings** tab, verify that **Cutter** is set to "*Partial Cut*" or "*Cut at End of Document*" (if your printer has an auto-cutter).
4. Click **Print Test Page** to confirm Windows can print cleanly.

4. Configuring Printers in Ice Talk POS Software

Once your printers are installed in Windows, linking them inside Ice Talk POS takes only 30 seconds:

1. Launch **Ice Talk POS** (**Ice Talk POS 1.0.0.exe**).
2. Log in as **Administrator** or **Super Admin**.
3. In the top navigation bar, click the "**Printers**" button (with printer icon).
4. In the setup window that appears:
 - **Separate Station Printers Routing:** Toggle switch to **ON**.
 - **Cashier / Billing Printer:** Select **POS-Cashier**.
 - **Rice & Kitchen Printer:** Select **POS-Kitchen**.
 - **Juice Bar & Desserts Printer:** Select **POS-Juice**.
 - **Buns & Short Eats Printer:** Select **POS-Buns**.
 - **Thermal Paper Width:** Select **78mm / 80mm Standard Roll**.
 - **Auto-Print on Order Approval:** Ensure switch is **ON**.
5. **Run the Test Print:** Click the orange "**Test**" button next to each station dropdown. Your physical printers will instantly print a test slip confirming communication!
6. Click "**Save & Close**".

Note for Single Printer Setup: If you currently only have 1 printer at the cashier desk, simply leave "Separate Station Printers Routing" **OFF**. The POS will print a single master KOT divided into clean sections ([RICE & KITCHEN], [JUICE & DESSERTS], [BUNS & SHORT EATS]). When you buy new printers, just switch the toggle to **ON**.

5. How Daily Operations & KOT Printing Work

Sample Printed KOT Ticket Output (78mm Width)

```
=====
KOT - RICE & KITCHEN
User: WAITER 1
Table: TABLE 04
Round: 1
Time: 9/22/2026 10:15 AM
-----
2 x SPECIAL MIXED FRIED RICE
* Extra chili paste
1 x CHEESE CHICKEN KOTTU
-----
KOT
=====
```

Operational Rules & Zero-Paper-Waste Intelligence

- **Order Approval Trigger:** When an order is accepted in the **"Order Receive"** screen or created directly in **"POS Billing"**, the background print engine automatically fires.
- **Silent Background Printing:** In the desktop executable, print jobs run silently in the background without opening any Windows print pop-ups or disturbing the cashier.
- **Zero Paper Waste:** If a customer at Table 02 orders *only* Mango Juice and Chocolate Brownie, the **Juice Bar printer prints**, while the Kitchen and Bun printers **remain completely silent**.
- **Re-printing Slips:** If a chef or runner loses a ticket, open **Orders Monitor** (</admin/orders>), click on the order card, and hit **"Print KOT"** to re-print on demand.

6. Troubleshooting & FAQ

SYMPTOM	LIKELY CAUSE	SOLUTION
Printer doesn't print test page	USB cable loose or printer turned off	Check power cable and USB/LAN port. Ensure blue power light is ON and paper roll is loaded correctly.
Printer prints blank white paper	Paper roll inserted upside down	Thermal paper is heat-sensitive on one side only. Turn the roll around and reload.
Printers not showing in POS dropdown	Printers installed after POS was opened	Click the orange "Re-scan" button inside the Printer Settings modal to reload Windows devices.
Network printer stopped responding	Router assigned a new IP address	In your router settings, set a <i>Static DHCP Reservation</i> for the printer's MAC address so its IP never changes.
Text is cutting off on the right edge	Paper size set to 58mm instead of 78mm	Open Printer Settings in the POS and select "78mm / 80mm Standard Roll" .